

Addy Betts - Private Chef Portfolio (*Private Chef and Culinary Portfolio*)

Website type: Portfolio

a) Section 1: Website Type and Purpose

For this project, I would like to make a professional portfolio that includes showcases of my culinary work. I want to explain how I use art to illustrate flavor combinations, and how studying cultures is important when making ethnic dishes. It's cool to research on a region you are making food from to be able to cite a few facts and history about the food to keep people engaged. When I cook for family or friends I will do this sometimes. It creates a more personal and memorable experience, and makes the experience of making food more fulfilling.

b) Home Page Content

Website title:

By Addy
Private Chef & Culinary Portfolio

Welcome Statement:

Welcome to my culinary portfolio, a collection of my experiences, creativity, and work as a private chef. Here, I share some of the dishes I have created and the experiences that have shaped my approach to food.

Purpose and Goals:

As a chef, my passion for cooking comes from the creativity of connection across the world. When we set foot in a setting where we are sharing culinary experiences, it's not just about the food. It's also about stories, history, and culture. The purpose of this portfolio is to display my culinary work, document my experiences, and demonstrate the skills I have developed through cooking. I want visitors to get a sense of who I am through the food I create and care that I put into each meal. As I grow my skills, my goal is to expand flavors and explore all types of new styles of cooking, and use this portfolio as a record of my growth and creativity.

Favorite Quote / Saying:

"Good food should feel personal"

Hero Image:

High quality photographs of a few finished meals that I have personally prepared. Taken by phone camera, or digital camera (whichever looks more professional), and my favorite food will be used as the main hero image to represent my cooking style.

Section 3: About Page

About me:

My name is Addy Betts, and I am a student at the University of Missouri with interests in marketing, creativity, food, and digital content. Cooking has become another way for me to express my creativity and create experiences for other people. Through private cheffing, I have gained experience planning meals, preparing different dishes, working with ingredients, presenting food, and adapting meals to the people I am cooking for. I also have professional experience working in restaurants both back of house and front of house, which has given me a better understanding of food service and the importance of creating a positive experience for my guests. My background in marketing and digital merchandising has also influenced the way I think about presentation and personal branding. Through this portfolio, I want to bring these different interests together and showcase both my culinary work and my growth as a creative professional.

Education:

University: University of Missouri - Columbia

Degree: Bachelor of Interdisciplinary Studies with emphasis on marketing, finance, and philosophy.

Focus: Hospitality Management

School: College of Arts and Science

Expected Graduation: 2026

Professional Photograph:

[INSERT PROFESSIONAL HEADSHOT HERE]

Resume

Resume File: Bettsresume.pdf

The final website will provide visitors with access to a pdf copy of my professional resume.

Resume video

[30-60 minute long video]

For this video I would like to make an introduction of my education and a little bit about what I do, but I think the best way for me to go about this, is if I make a quick family style sit down meal and have a bite of it after I talk. I think for this meal I will make salmon crudo, and explain that because most people think most sushi is Japanese, they would expect sushi to have been invented in Japan. However, it was invented in Norway blah blah. Maybe make a tik tok style vlog that is under 60 seconds?

Section 4: Projects & Experience**Project 1: Private Chef Dinner****Description**

One experience I plan to feature in my portfolio is a private dinner that I prepared from beginning to end. Preparing a complete meal requires more than simply cooking individual dishes. I had to think about how the different foods would work together, determine what ingredients I needed, organize the preparation process, manage my time, and make sure everything was ready to serve at the appropriate time. Presentation was also important to me because I wanted the finished meal to look as appealing as it tasted. This experience represents the type of private-chef work I enjoy because it allowed me to be creative while also creating a meal specifically for the people I was serving.

Planned Artifacts

- Photograph of the completed meal
- Photograph of someone who plated the dish (me) and someone or group of people who ate.

Reflection

This experience helped me understand how much planning goes into preparing an entire meal rather than just one dish. I learned that timing and organization are just as important as cooking ability. It also gave me an opportunity to experiment with presentation and think more intentionally about how each part of a meal works together. It made me more confident in preparing complete meals for other people.

Project 2: Menu Development and Food Presentation

Description

Another area I want to showcase is my experience developing meals and experimenting with food presentation. When I cook, I enjoy thinking about more than just a recipe. I like to think about history, philosophy, and the sociology of food. I want to create an atmosphere where I can educate my clients on a particular dish or region, so they can have a good experience and want to come back. It's different than traditional private cheffing because I am creating a more personable experience that they can leave with. It will be more likely to stay in their memories.

Planned Artifacts:

- Appropriate photo of food presentation
- Possibly a photograph of me with notes or making a powerpoint? Some kind of photo that demonstrates I educate while presenting.

Project 3: Hospitality and restaurant experience

- My restaurant experience from fine dining Italian and Indian cuisine to Ma and Pa's sushi restaurants, demonstrate that I am someone with quite an intriguing background. I am always trying to learn more, and do things that are outside of my comfort zone. In addition to the food itself, I have also provided a space where I can communicate with guests and coworkers to handle any problems, or to just have good old fashioned conversation. Working in real time fast paced restaurants have also taught me knowledge on preparing food on time, starting with appetizers, pairing with wine or cocktails, and distracting clients from waiting for their meals. I believe that a successful

experience requires an understanding of what the client wants and making them feel comfortable.

Planned artifacts;

- Pictures displaying appetizer plates with people around the table, something like salami or cheese
- Resume or another artifact that displays my professional experience (selfie of me in apron at my old job)

Reflection:

Working on different dishes has taught me that cooking involves a lot of experimentation. Not everything turns out exactly how I imagine it the first time, and I have learned to adjust ingredients, preparation methods, and presentation as I go. It's easier to be prepared when cooking for clients, family, or friends so you can also have time for conversating and focusing on connecting with your client.

Project 4: Culinary Photography and Content Creating**Description**

Food photography and content creation combine my interest in cooking with my background in marketing and digital content. After preparing a dish, I enjoy thinking about how I can photograph or videograph to present it in a way that is alluring to the eye. This is especially relevant for a culinary portfolio because visitors cannot actually taste the food they see online.

Planned Artifacts;

- Two examples of dishes I have prepared
- Before and after example of plating

Reflection:

Photographing my food has made me pay more attention to presentation while I am cooking. I have learned that a dish can taste great but lack visual appearance, hence why it is important for a professional chef to have professional looking pictures.

Section 5 : Personal Reflection

Cooking has always been more interesting to me when there is something behind the food besides just following a recipe. I think food is a form of art, but it is also a way to learn about people, history, and different cultures. When I decide to make a dish from a certain region, I like researching where it came from and why people prepare it the way they do. Even learning one or two interesting facts about a dish makes the process more fulfilling to me. I can share

that information with the people I am cooking for, and suddenly we are not just sitting down and eating. There is a story and conversation that comes with the meal.

My experience working in restaurants has also changed the way I think about hospitality. I have worked around different types of food and in both front and back of house environments. One thing I have learned is that people do not only remember whether their food tasted good. They remember the entire experience. They remember the conversations they had, how they were treated, what they drank with their meal, and the atmosphere around them. Working in fast-paced restaurants has taught me how to communicate with people, manage my time, solve problems in the moment, and pay attention to what a guest needs. I want to bring those same skills into private cheffing while making the experience feel more personal.

I also think my education and interests outside of cooking make my approach a little different. I am interested in marketing, finance, philosophy, art, and digital content, and I find myself connecting those subjects to food in different ways. Marketing has made me think more about presentation and how something is communicated visually, while philosophy and sociology make me curious about why people have certain traditions surrounding food in the first place. Culinary photography is another way I can combine these interests. A person looking at my website cannot taste something I made, so the photography, presentation, writing, and story behind the dish have to make them interested in experiencing it for themselves.

My career goals are still developing, but I know I want creativity and human connection to be a part of whatever I do. With private cheffing, I would like to continue learning about different cuisines, improve my techniques, and become more confident creating complete dining experiences for other people. I do not necessarily want my food to feel like something that could be ordered at any restaurant. I want to create meals around the people I am cooking for and give them something memorable to take away from the experience. This portfolio will give me a place to document that growth and hopefully show how my cooking style changes as I continue learning about food, culture, and the people I get to cook for.